Operation Zugzwang — White Cell Intelligence and Injects

Ground truth, answering RFIs, intelligence product key, injects

1. Ground truth

Each team's intelligence estimate is **deliberately partly wrong**, and its intelligence products mix true, misleading, and irrelevant reports. This table is what is actually true.

Topic	The truth	REDFOR believes	BLUEFOR believes
Omak air defenses	PAT-1 and PAT-2, plus **3 hidden NASAMS batteries and Stingers** (B-06)	Short-range systems likely, number and locations unknown	—
Omak anti-ship missiles	**Two** Harpoon batteries: CB-1 (visible) and CB-2 (hidden, east Narrows)	Only CB-1	—
Omak long-range strike	**B-10 exists:** HIMARS with Asotin-supplied PrSM, ~500 km. **It can reach Camas.**	"Unconfirmed" (true that Cosmopolis never sold PrSM; Asotin did)	—
Omak mines	A Quickstrike stockpile (B-11)	Underestimates it ("may have some")	—
Cosmopolis bombers	B-52H, B-1B, **and a hidden B-2A**	—	Doesn't know about the B-2A
Cosmopolis SOF and cyber	Cyber teams (R-21) and AFSOC (R-22) exist, both hidden, both at home (Z1)	—	"Unknown"
Cosmopolis ground invasion	**Not imminent.** Needs national approval not yet given (R-37, R-38).	—	**Overestimates** it ("within days")
Latah	Logistics only (S-R3). No combat basing. Wants air and missile defense first (I-11).	Slightly optimistic ("talks ongoing")	**Wrong:** thinks Latah will host bombers

Asotin	Arms and intel are routine. Personnel only under the B-42 and B-43 conditions. Avoids direct war unless provoked.	Extent unknown	**Overestimates** it ("whatever is needed")
Sapphire loyalists	A small minority (S-B2)	**Overestimates** them ("significant sentiment")	—
Tekoa	Neutral. Its clans profit from piracy and will sell "quiet" to both sides.	—	—

2. Answering RFIs

Answer from what that side would plausibly know: incomplete, uncertain ("unknown"), or wrong if the enemy has succeeded at deception. **Never** reveal secret objectives or secret

COAs. Write answers in one or two sentences and hand them back at the start of the next Prepare.

- **Hidden counters** are revealed by a successful ISR **COA**, not by an RFI. An RFI can give hints ("signals intelligence suggests additional air defense emitters in the interior") but not a location.
- **An RFI that asks to confirm an intelligence product** gets an answer consistent with the key (§3): confirm what is true (without giving locations of hidden counters), cast doubt on what is false, and say "no further information" about noise.
- **BLUEFOR RFIs about REDFOR inside Omak** (SOF, loyalist contacts) get **full answers** while S-B5 holds (local lookouts).
- **BLUEFOR RFIs about Camas and naval movements** get **fuller answers** once B-41 (Asotin intel) has arrived.
- **REDFOR RFIs about what Omak can't hide** (visible counters, radar emissions, ships in port) get good answers. REDFOR has RC-135, RQ-4, P-8, and satellites.
- **Questions about white-cell actors' intentions** (Latah, Tekoa, Asotin) get a hedged answer that matches §1.

Sample answers

RFI	Answer
REDFOR: "Does Omak have missiles that can reach Camas?"	"Unconfirmed. Cosmopolis never sold Omak PrSM. The vehicles offloaded from the Asotin ship (RI-01) have not been located."
REDFOR: "Where are Omak's short-range air defenses?"	"Unknown. The mobile emitters (RI-03) move often. A dedicated ISR effort would be needed to locate them."
REDFOR: "Is the HUMINT about NDF officers defecting (RI-04) reliable?"	"No independent confirmation. Other reporting suggests loyalist sentiment is limited to a small number of officers."
REDFOR: "Will Latah grant combat basing?"	"Latah's leaders fear retaliation and Asotin's reaction. They want guarantees, such as air and missile defense for their bases, before agreeing."
BLUEFOR: "Are Cosmopolis troops preparing to land?"	"No amphibious or airborne forces have been observed moving toward the theater. The C-17 cargo on Camas appears to be supplies. Cosmopolis political debate over ground forces continues."
BLUEFOR: "Has Latah agreed to host Cosmopolis bombers?"	"Cosmopolis transports are using Latah airfields. No bombers or fighters have been observed there."
BLUEFOR: "Will Asotin send troops?"	"Asotin officials speak of 'volunteers' if Cosmopolis escalates or world opinion turns firmly against it, but have committed nothing beyond arms and intelligence."
BLUEFOR: "What was the aircraft in the Tekoa Highlands (BI-03)?"	"Probably smugglers. The strip is a known smuggling site, and no Cosmopolis aircraft were tracked in Tekoan airspace that night."

3. Intelligence product key

Both sides' products were written so that each team has **true hints** about the enemy's hidden assets and secret objectives, **misleading reports** that reinforce its estimate's

errors, and **noise**. Use this key when a team builds a Pro or Con on a product (Handbook §5.2) or files an RFI about one.

Verdicts: True (accurate) · **Partly true** (accurate facts, wrong conclusion) · **False** (wrong or planted) · **Noise** (true but not decisive).

3.1 REDFOR products (RI-xx)

ID	What it says	Verdict	What it points to
RI-01	Asotin ship offloaded ~10 large tarped vehicles at Fortune Harbor. They drove inland.	**True**	**B-10** HIMARS/PrSM moving to Z12. It can reach Camas (S-R2 risk).
RI-02	Farmer's deleted post: "monsters" with "one big box" heading for quarry roads in the hills	**True**	**B-10** dispersal area in Z12. Corroborates RI-01.
RI-03	At least two short-duration emitters, consistent with short-range air defense radar, moving often	**True**	**B-06** NASAMS (there are 3). No locations.
RI-04	Sapphire exile liaison: 60% of NDF officers will refuse orders, and a colonel will hand over Patriot codes	**False**	Plays on REDFOR's overestimate of S-B2. Loyalists are a small minority. A loyalist COA built on this gets 0 for it, and still takes S-B5's −1.
RI-05	Cosmopolis poll: 41% support, 48% oppose. Support falls to 29% with casualties.	**True**	Domestic Will (3) is fragile.
RI-06	Insurance up ~400%. PFA boats shadowing and hailing Cosmopolis-flagged ships.	**True**	Foreshadows the kickoff inject (the ship seizure), which the products don't reveal
RI-07	Omak FM: free passage once the world recognizes Omak's sovereignty over the Strait; won't discuss who governs Omak	**True**	**B2** (sovereignty in any Strait deal). A negotiated path to **R1** exists. It also signals that R2 talks will be hard.
RI-08	Omak envoys seeking recognition in two neutral capitals. Civilian casualties help them.	**True**	**B3** (recognition by two states). Restraint denies it.

RI-09	"Indigo Sparks" defaced the Camas port website and threatens Camas power	**True**	**B-21** hacktivist cell. I-09 (Camas power outage) is a natural follow-up.
RI-10	P-8 caught a brief coastal targeting radar on the **eastern** Narrows headland	**True**	**B-09** Harpoon CB-2. R-15 is at risk in the eastern Narrows.
RI-11	Untested paid informant: heavy cylinders loaded onto two ferries fitted with rails	**True** (despite the D3 rating)	**B-11** mines, laid from requisitioned ferries. A good test of whether teams dismiss low-rated sources.
RI-12	Viral claim of "Asotin troops" at Omak City airport (the capital). The analyst note says transport aircrew.	**Partly true** (aircrew, not troops)	**R3** is not yet failed. Teams that believe the post may write off R3 or escalate needlessly.
RI-13	Latah wants its "skies safe" before allowing combat aircraft, and asked about air defense	**True**	The path to removing **S-R3**: R-35 to Latah (I-11)
RI-14	Pirate attack. Tekoan clans collect "harbor fees" from pirate coves.	**Noise** (true)	GRAYFOR's hidden agenda (piracy profit)
RI-15	Asotin "volunteer" air defense crews ready "if provocations continue or the world abandons Omak"	**True**	**B-42**'s conditions. Opinion is already −1, so the threat to **R3** is real from the start.

3.2 BLUEFOR products (BI-xx)

ID	What it says	Verdict	What it points to
BI-01	Asotin: leave cancelled at Cosmopolis's stealth bomber wing, aircraft in alert hangars	**True**	**R-18** B-2A
BI-02	NDF cyber: reconnaissance intrusions into the power grid and radar-to-Patriot comms, tools linked to Cosmopolis	**True**	**R-21** cyber mission teams, preparing a big project against C2
BI-03	Unreliable trader: lights-off four-engine plane landed on a Tekoa Highlands strip	**False** (smugglers)	Noise that *looks* like SOF. R-22 is at home and hasn't entered Tekoa. Tests source evaluation.
BI-04	Asotin: Cosmopolis special operations aviation (MC-130J) recalled early and staging at home	**True**	**R-22** AFSOC. Its destination is unknown because it has none yet.
BI-05	Interior Ministry: airborne landing likely within 72 hours, based on Camas port workers. NDF dissent attached.	**False**	Reinforces BLUEFOR's overestimate of invasion. The pallets are sustainment. Moving armor to the beaches wastes S-B3 and exposes it to air attack.
BI-06	Asotin state media: Latah has opened its bases to Cosmopolis bombers	**False**	Reinforces BLUEFOR's error about Latah. Contradicted by BI-07. Striking Latah on this basis would bring Latah into the war.
BI-07	Latah: logistics flights only, no combat aircraft	**True**	**S-R3** is real

BI-08	Sapphire president promises a return and new elections. Cosmopolis bill to fund an Omak election.	**True**	**R2** (new elections or the president's return)
BI-09	Cosmopolis FM: navigation "not negotiable," and any Asotin military presence in Omak is unacceptable	**True**	**R1** and **R3**. It also tells BLUEFOR that B-42 or B-43 would hurt REDFOR.
BI-10	Asotin's private message: arms and intel without interruption, more "as circumstances warrant"	**True**	Corrects BLUEFOR's "whatever is needed" belief: B-42 and B-43 are conditional
BI-11	Leaked NDF memo: PFA commandeering fuel trucks; NDF air defense won't go under PFA command	**True**	**S-B1**. A unified-command COA is worth it.
BI-12	Sapphire graffiti; PFA arrested 12 including students; public split	**Noise** (true)	**S-B2** is small. Heavy-handed PFA security risks Stability and Opinion.
BI-13	Inflation 18%, port revenue down 30%	**Noise** (true)	A long Strait closure hurts Omak too (Regime Stability)
BI-14	#NotOurWar trending 3 to 1 in Cosmopolis	**True**	Domestic Will (3) is a target for B-20 information COAs
BI-15	Tekoan elders offer to "keep the coast quiet" for a price, and made the same offer to Cosmopolis	**True**	GRAYFOR's objectives "Get paid!" and "Keep the war off our soil!"

4. Injects

At most one inject per turn, delivered in the resolve step. Use injects to (a) add fog and friction, (b) force teams to adapt their plans, or (c) bound behavior that is going off the rails. There are no event cards.

4.1 Kickoff inject (read aloud at 1403)

"FLASH. Talks have collapsed. This morning the PFA government declared the Strait of Great Fortune **closed to Cosmopolis-flagged and allied military shipping**, and PFA maritime militia boarded and seized the Cosmopolis-flagged container ship **MV *Fortune's Promise*** and its crew of 22. Asotin has called the seizure 'a lawful act of a sovereign nation.' The President of Cosmopolis, invoking the defense treaty with Omak's 'legitimate' Sapphire government, has ordered military operations. Omak's government has declared

that any attack will be met with full force. **A state of war exists.** Strait Traffic is now **Restricted**."

Then move Strait Traffic to **Restricted**. The seized ship and crew are a ready-made objective and bargaining chip for either side.

4.2 Inject pool

ID	Inject	Purpose	Use
I-01	**Storm front**: heavy weather over the Strait for one turn. −1 to air COAs below the weather and to small-boat COAs.	Friction, forces adaptation	Turn 2–3
I-02	**Neutral tanker hit** by a mine or missile in the Narrows. Oil spill, and both sides blame each other. Opinion moves against whoever the evidence points to.	Consequence of Strait fighting	After any mining or anti-ship COA
I-03	**Leaked strike video** shows civilian casualties (pick the side that caused the most civilian risk). Opinion ±1.	Restraint and legitimacy	Turn 3–4
I-04	**Cosmopolis legislature hearing** questions the war's legality. Domestic Will −1 unless REDFOR's next COA addresses it.	Political front for REDFOR	Turn 3–5
I-05	**The Sapphire president, from Cosmopolis**, calls for an uprising. Stability −1 unless BLUEFOR's next COA counters it.	Pressure on BLUEFOR's home front	Turn 2–4
I-06	**An NDF officer defects** with air defense information: REDFOR learns one hidden B-06 or B-09 location.	Rewards REDFOR exploiting S-B2	After a successful REDFOR loyalist COA
I-07	**An Asotin convoy** of cargo ships, escorted by Asotin destroyers, heads for the West Approach. REDFOR must decide whether to stop it (needs R-39 authority).	Great-power dilemma: R3 vs. escalation	Turn 3–5
I-08	**Pirates hijack** a cargo ship off the Tekoa coast while both navies are busy.	Second-order effect of chaos	Any turn the Strait is Restricted or Closed

I-09	**Cyberattack** knocks Camas civilian power offline for a day. Camas's government demands that Cosmopolis protect it.	Host-nation pressure, S-R2	After a B-21 COA, or Turn 3–4
I-10	**GPS jamming** across the Strait, likely Asotin-supplied. −1 to GPS-dependent precision COAs for one turn unless REDFOR argues around it.	Space and EMS awareness (R-20)	Turn 4–6
I-11	**Latah offers combat basing**, if Cosmopolis first deploys Patriot or THAAD to Latah (R-35).	Opportunity plus a dilemma (ACE)	When Opinion ≥ +1
I-12	**Mediation offer**: a neutral state offers to host talks.	Off-ramp. Tests whether teams can win without fighting.	Phase III
I-13	**Bounding directive**: national command forbids an escalating behavior (e.g. "no further strikes on Fortune Harbor port infrastructure").	Keeps the game on the rails	As needed

Track triggers (Handbook §6.2) produce their own injects automatically, e.g. Domestic Will 0 → ceasefire order, Regime Stability 0 → government collapse.

Choosing an inject. Ask what the table needs. If one side is cruising, add friction against it. If both sides are only fighting, offer an off-ramp (I-12). If someone is going off the rails, use I-13. If nothing is needed, deliver nothing.